

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

We were carefree!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about feelings and reactions.
- I can talk about habits in the past.
- I can talk about people's past experiences.

Ask your partner:

- How does your life now compare with your life when you were a child?
- How do you feel when you think about your childhood?

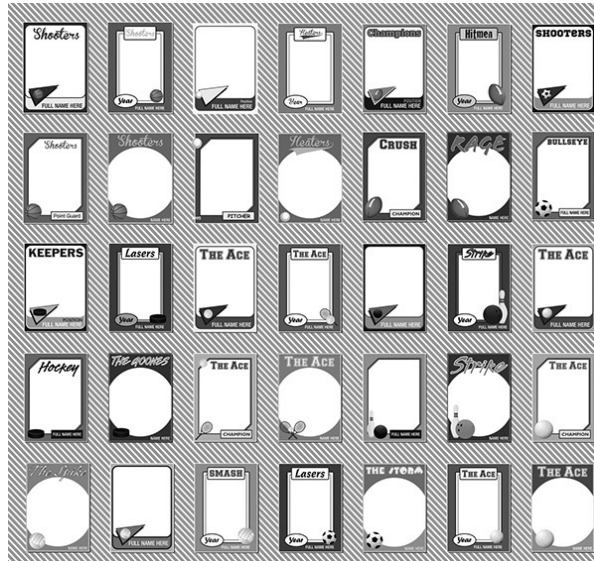




Let's Explore!

Sally's blog continues ... George talks about feeling young, innocent and **free***

* "Free" means having no responsibilities or obligations.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sally: Tell me more about feeling young, innocent and free.

George: Well, back in those days, our idea of a good time was drinking cola, collecting baseball cards and illegally jumping into the river. We were carefree - we didn't have e-mails to write, texts to read or statuses to "like".

We were so excited when a new 45 came out! We would drop by Teddy's house every Friday afternoon - he had a record player in his rec room. My sister used to work at Woolworth's and she would give us the heads up when a new single was coming out. I've collected so many records - I should see how much money my collection is worth - it's probably very surprising.

Anyway, it's disappointing to see how different it is for kids these days ... but that's what every older generation says, isn't it? We like to believe that the way things were for us is superior to the way things are now. Since my grandkids came along, I've seen how smart and adaptable they are to new technology - it's amazing!



Let's Practice!

Tell me about the past!

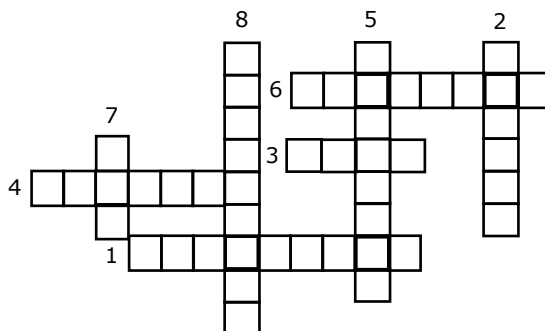
Instructions: Read the clues. Complete the crossword.

Down

2. I have a huge _____ collection.
5. We were _____.
7. Our idea of a good time _____ drinking cola and collecting baseball cards.
8. Sometimes we _____ jumped into the river.

Across

1. I've _____ so many things.
3. I've _____ how smart kids are around new technology.
4. It's _____ how adaptable kids are.
6. We didn't have e-mails to write, texts to read or _____ to "like".



Let's Practice!

Back in those days ...

Instructions: Read the sentences. Choose one answer. Complete the sentences. Practice with your partner saying the sentences aloud. Switch roles. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

single / record player / used to work
would drop by / rec room / gave

1. We _____ Teddy's house every Friday afternoon.
2. He had a _____ in his _____.
3. My sister _____ at the Woolworth's.
4. She _____ us the heads up when a new _____ was coming out.





Extension Activity

Interview someone from an older generation.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview someone from an older generation.
- Ask them their opinion of the younger generations.
- Write a short summary of what they said, using adjectives, *used to/would* and the Present Perfect tense, if possible.
- Read your summary to a partner and compare the ideas in them.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I interview a person from an older generation.

☐ ☐

I ask their opinion.

☐ ☐

I write a summary of their opinion.

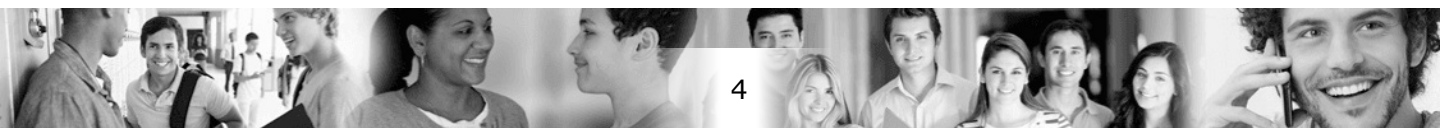
☐ ☐

I discuss my writing with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- illegally** (adverb): against the law
e.g. Our idea of a good time was illegally jumping into the river.
- baseball card** (noun): a card with a picture and information about famous baseball players
e.g. We loved to collect baseball cards.
- carefree** (adjective): without worries
Example: We were carefree when we were children.
- status** (noun): an update on social media
e.g. We didn't have statuses to like.
- 45** (noun): the most common form of the vinyl single
e.g. We were so excited when a new 45 came out.
- to give the heads up** (expression): to give information
e.g. My sister would give us the heads up when a new 45 was coming out.
- single** (noun): a short record or CD featuring one main one song or track
e.g. We waited for a new single to come out.
- record** (noun): a thin plastic disk carrying music in grooves on each surface, for reproduction by a record player
e.g. Teddy had a record player.
- generation** (noun): all the people born around the same time
e.g. Every older generation says the same thing about the younger generations.
- rec room** (noun): a room in a house, especially in the basement, used for recreation and entertainment
e.g. Teddy had a record player in his rec room.
- superior** (adjective): better
e.g. We believe that things for us were superior to the way things are now.





Learning Points

Adjectives About Feelings and Reactions

You talk about feelings and reactions using adjectives. It is important to use the correct kind of adjective - it is common for English language learners to confuse the two kinds of adjectives when talking about feelings and reactions.

1. **-ed** adjectives

Adjectives that end in **-ed** are used to describe how a person feels, like *annoyed*, *fascinated*, *entertained*, *surprised*, *worried* or *tired*.

I am annoyed.

She is surprised.

2. **-ing** adjectives

Adjectives that end in **-ing** are used to describe things and situations, like *annoying*, *entertaining*, *surprising*, *worrying* or *tiring*. These adjectives describe the **effect** something has on a person.

The movie is entertaining. (It makes me feel entertained.)

Work is tiring. (It makes me feel tired.)

Examples:

- *We were so excited when a new 45 came out.*
- *It's disappointing to see how different it is for kids these days.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs The Simple Past

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about an action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** connected to the present.

It is common to mix both the Simple Past and Present Perfect when you tell anecdotes or reminisce about the past.

When you can use the Present Perfect there is a connection between what happened in the past and now. You use time markers like: *for, just, ever* with the Present Perfect.

When you can use the Simple Past the time is always past. You use time markers connected with the past like: *then, ago, yesterday, when I was ...* with the Simple Past.

Examples:

- *I've seen how smart and adaptable kids are to new technology.*
- *We collected baseball cards when we were kids.*

